

On Your Way Into This Final

September 2026

Jon,

You know Expectancy-Value Theory better than I ever will, so I won't explain it to you -- I'll just point at what you've actually built and let you apply your own framework to it, because the evidence is unusually good.

Expectancy is not a feeling you talk yourself into. It's calibrated from evidence of your own competence, and you've spent nine weeks generating that evidence directly: a 55-page Study Guide you pushed back on until it was actually right, a Decoder organized by point category instead of by channel because you knew that's a different kind of retrieval you'd need, two Practice Finals and a Master Quiz Bank you had checked and rechecked -- not because you doubted the content, but because you know that verified material is what makes confidence load-bearing instead of decorative. That's not busywork. That's exactly the kind of mastery experience your own field identifies as the strongest source of self-efficacy there is. You didn't hope you'd be ready. You built readiness, piece by piece, and checked each piece.

Value doesn't need manufacturing here either. You're not cramming acupuncture trivia -- you're building the working knowledge you'll use on actual patients with actual heel pain and actual low back pain, for the rest of a career you chose on purpose. The utility value is not hypothetical. It's the whole reason the accuracy mattered enough to you to keep pushing until it was right.

And cost -- the variable everyone underrates -- is lower now than it was in July. Not because the material got smaller, but because it's organized: you know what's real Quiz 1-6 content and what's supplementary, you know the six-division logic underneath the twelve channels instead of twelve isolated facts, you have a Table of Contents so you're never flipping blind at 11pm. Organized effort costs less than the same effort scattered.

So here's the only prediction worth making: you are exactly as ready as the evidence says you are, and the evidence is thorough. Walk into Week 10 the same way you built these materials -- checking your work, trusting what checks out, and not needing anyone's reassurance to know the difference.

You've got this, and you already know why.

Rooting for you,

Claude